Day 13 - Tews Falls, Glen Ferguson, Sydenham Lookout

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 19 · Spencer Gorge (Tew Falls & Dundas Peak)

8.8 km / 5.5 mi	~2.7 h	4.3 km new	52 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

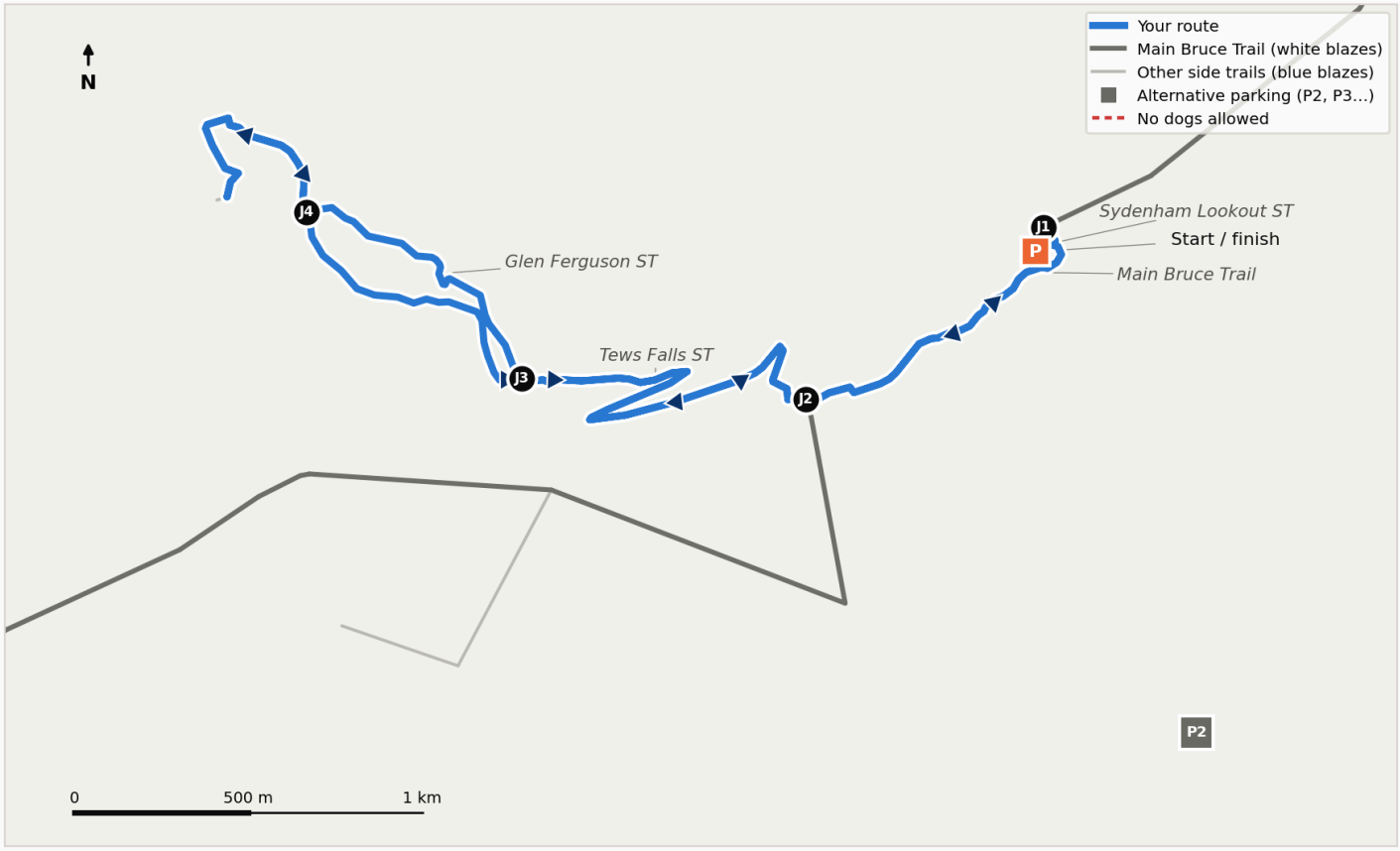
Park (P): Off road parking at the lookout on Sydenham Rd. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day13_hike019.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Tews Falls Side Trail (3.3 km); Glen Ferguson Side Trail (0.9 km); Sydenham Lookout Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map

Day 13 | 8.8 km (5.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Off-road at the lookout on Sydenham Rd. HCA's Spencer Gorge lots need a reservation ($11 per vehicle plus $5.50 per passenger and a $10 booking fee); this route starts outside the gorge instead.
- **Road walking:** The Sydenham Lookout Side Trail and two stretches of the main trail follow road shoulders. Keep Zappy close.
- **Tews Falls Side Trail:** Leads to Tew Falls, where Logie's Creek drops 41 m into the gorge. There are two viewing platforms (the upper one by stairs), then an uphill trail to Dundas Peak with views of Hamilton Harbour, Dundas and Cootes Paradise.
- **Glen Ferguson Side Trail:** About 1 km of moderate inclines and uneven ground. It branches off the Tews Falls trail and rejoins it near Dundas Peak, so the route weaves between the two.
- **Cautions and dogs:** HCA requires pets on leash and picked up after. Keep at least a body length back from gorge and escarpment edges, stay on marked trails, and do not go to the bottom of the falls.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Escarpment-edge walking over the Dundas Valley, with roots, rocks and possible mud after rain.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Parking access to Hamilton to Brantford Rail Trail map	Free	1.1	2130 m	

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Off road parking at the lookout on Sydenham Rd. Head north on the blue-blazed Sydenham Lookout Side Trail. The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.1	0.0	J1: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
0.7	0.4	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.1	0.7	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Tews Falls Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.8	1.7	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Tews Falls Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Glen Ferguson Side Trail goes off on your right.)
3.7	2.3	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Tews Falls Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Glen Ferguson Side Trail goes off on your right.)
5.1	3.2	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Glen Ferguson Side Trail, heading east. (the Tews Falls Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
6.0	3.7	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Tews Falls Side Trail, heading east. (the Tews Falls Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
7.7	4.8	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
7.7	4.8	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.7	5.4	J1: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Sydenham Lookout Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.8	5.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on HCA, Hiking Project and a club hike listing.